mense power through the large arterial tube crowning the broad base of the heart, called the aorta. Directly after receiving the first flow of the arterial fluid, the aorta divides like an arch to the right and left, and again subdivides into four main trunks,—two branches of which extend upward, when they are called the carotid arteries, and supply the different portions of the throat and head; the other two trunks tend downward, and branch off on either side of the body into a complex system of tubing, ending in an inextricable net-work of fine hair-like passages called capillaries. The ramifications of this extensive system of vessels are supposed to extend to a length of several miles, and it is thus that arterial blood is furnished to the body, supplying the entire system with nutrition and the life-giving oxygen inhaled through the lungs.

In the capillaries, the blood parts with its nutritive qualities, and from thence it is taken up by the veins, the extent and ramifications of which correspond in all respects with the arteries, only that its dark purple hue denotes the absence of the vitalizing element found in the arteries; but it must be remembered that the chief office of the veins is to carry the blood back again to the great central reservoir of circulatory power in the heart. This they effect by being distributed side by side with the arteries,—intersecting them in thousands of yards of fine hair-like tubing, until they expand into larger proportions, and finally concentrate into four main trunks about the heart, corresponding to the position of the arteries. The large trunks which